

JESSE HEIDNER

SENIOR MANAGER, SOFTWARE QUALITY ENGINEERING

jhheidner@gmail.com | (425) 443-8997

PROFILE

QA leader who builds quality as an engineering system—not a checkpoint. With 15+ years of experience, specializes in designing and scaling end-to-end quality strategies across hardware-integrated, cloud-based platforms. Proven ability to transform manual testing organizations into automation-driven, data-informed quality engines. Experienced in integrating hardware and software validation into CI/CD pipelines, driving shift-left adoption, and establishing KPIs such as defect leakage, coverage, and system reliability. Strong cross-functional partner to engineering, hardware, and product teams, aligning quality with business outcomes and system performance at scale.

CORE COMPETENCIES

QA Leadership & Mentorship

Led and coached QA engineers across multiple initiatives

Test Strategy & Planning

Designs test plans, test cases, and quality approaches from requirements

Automation Frameworks

Selenium, Playwright, Cucumber, API automation

Manual & Exploratory Testing

Identifies edge cases and user behavior risks

Performance Testing

Experience with performance and load testing concepts (JMeter/LoadRunner familiarity)

API & Integration Testing

Postman, REST validation, backend testing

Defect Management & Reporting

Jira tracking, root cause analysis, trend reporting

SQL & Data Validation

Query and validate backend data

CI/CD & DevOps

Jenkins, Git, automation integration

Client Engagement & Communication

Translates business needs into effective QA strategies

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SENIOR QA MANAGER, Amazon

Apr 2021 to Dec 2024

- Led a team of QA engineers, achieving a 65% reduction in production defect leakage by enhancing test coverage and implementing risk-based testing practices.
- Engineered automation frameworks using Selenium and Playwright in Python, attaining over 90% automation coverage and reducing regression cycles from two weeks to less than one day through effective CI/CD integration.
- Developed and executed comprehensive test strategies, including requirements review and release validation, ensuring alignment with business objectives and technical specifications.
- Increased component test coverage by 80% through the implementation of various testing methodologies, including comparison screenshot testing, unit, and component tests.
- Coordinated with engineering and product teams to align testing efforts with Agile/Scrum methodologies, enhancing overall release management and quality outcomes.

Business Owner – Senior QA Consultant / Engineer, Ironclad Quality Solutions

Jan 2025 to Present

- Owned client-facing Quality Assurance delivery by developing comprehensive Test Strategies and Test Plans, enhancing product quality and increasing release confidence.
- Executed hands-on manual, automated, and API testing using Postman, transforming requirements into detailed test cases and actionable defect reports to expedite resolution with engineering teams.
- Engineered Selenium automation in JavaScript, achieving a significant reduction in repetitive regression tasks while improving test coverage consistency across releases.
- Led and coached QA engineers, fostering effective communication and strategic planning through the creation of Test Plan Templates, Daily Status Reports, and issue logs.

QA TECHNICAL LEAD, Amazon

Jul 2014 to Apr 2021

- Owned the QA automation architecture for a distributed web platform, designing and maintaining Selenium WebDriver and Playwright frameworks, while integrating with CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and Git to enhance release feedback.
- Engineered automated UI and API test suites to validate end-to-end service behavior, significantly improving regression coverage of critical customer-facing flows and boosting release confidence.
- Executed SQL-based backend validation to ensure data integrity and verify service-to-service integration, proactively identifying potential issues that could impact customer experience prior to release.
- Led defect triage during release cycles by prioritizing issues with engineering and product teams, validating fixes, and retesting high-risk areas to uphold quality standards.

QA Engineer, PopCap Games

May 2013 to Jun 2014

- Developed and maintained manual and automated test cases for web-based game systems, enhancing defect detection and product reliability.
- Managed build validation for regular releases, identifying quality risks early and improving team stability through effective communication with developers.

QA Team Lead - Xbox, Games for Windows, Microsoft

Feb 2011

- Led a QA team of over 30 testers, establishing and refining quality assurance processes for Xbox and Games for Windows releases in a dynamic environment.
- Engineered cross-platform test strategies that transformed product risks into actionable test plans, ensuring comprehensive coverage across various devices and operating systems.
- Optimized task management workflows to enhance transparency and accountability, providing stakeholders with regular updates on project status and quality metrics.

LINKS

[Website](#), [GitHub](#), [LinkedIn](#)

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- | | | | |
|--------------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| • Software Quality Engineering | • Test Automation | • Selenium | • Playwright |
| • Jira | • Test Strategy | • Test Plan | • Metrics Collection |
| • Agile | • SQL | • Performance Testing | • Process Improvement |
| • Leadership | • Communication | • People Management | • Strategic Planning |
| • Team Building | • Cloud Infrastructure | | |

CERTIFICATIONS

Selenium WebDriver Certification

Playwright Automation Certification

Cucumber BDD Certification